task of preparing the annual budget for approval by the General Assembly and determines the direction in which the funds will be allocated for different organs of the UN. He is also responsible for collecting the contribution from the member states and also controls the expenditure of the organs and specialized agencies of the UN.

Under Article 101, the Secretary-General, being the head of the Secretariat, appoints the staff under regulations established by the General Assembly. And it is his prime responsibility to secure the highest standards of efficiency, competence, and integrity. Besides these administrative functions, he has also been assigned a vital political function under Article 99, which states that the Secretary-General may bring to the attention of the Security Council any matter which, in his opinion, may threaten the maintenance of international peace and security. How the Secretary-General would exercise this function is left to the discretion of the incumbent. He should act as a conscience keeper for the whole world as, under Article 35, he has been conferred the status equivalent to a member state or that of the General Assembly. The most important thing to be remembered is that, under Article 100, the Secretary-General has to be politically neutral.

The Secretary-General represents the UN in all its negotiations and interactions with the member and non-member states and other international bodies. The Report of the Preparatory Committee upheld that “The Secretary-General more than anyone else will stand for the UN as a whole. In the eyes of the world, no less than in the eyes of his own staff, he must embody the principles and ideals of the Charter”.[13]

One of the most vital roles played by the Secretary-General is the use of his ‘good offices’—steps taken publicly and in private, drawing upon his independence, impartiality and integrity—to prevent international disputes from arising, escalating or spreading. Each Secretary-General also defines his role within the context of his particular time in office.

The Secretary-Generals of the UN till date are:

- Trygve Lie (Norway), from February 1946 until his resignation